



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

» APPRECIATION

Triumph in silence, heard everywhere

Away from the glare that follows most World Cups, India's women's visually impaired team **claimed history** in Colombo, lifting the inaugural Blind Women's T20 title.

Ashwin Achal

achal.ashwin@thehindu.co.in

Three weeks after the Indian women's team lifted its maiden ICC Women's World Cup title, their visually impaired counterparts scripted a triumph of equal heart and far greater hardship. On November 24 in Sri Lanka, the Indian women's visually impaired cricket team clinched the inaugural ICAB Blind World T20 title.

If the senior women's side had to

break through decades of neglect and underestimation, the road travelled by this team was even more arduous, marked by limited resources, social invisibility and a relentless fight just to earn the right to represent India.

Captain T.C. Deepika, who hails from Tumkur in Karnataka, captured that struggle with unfiltered honesty. "All the people in my village always said that I did not do anything of use.

Today, we have proved everyone wrong," said Deepika, a B3 (partially sighted) player.

The magnitude of that victory ensured the team's return home was anything but ordinary. Meeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi was a moment etched in memory. The players presented him with an autographed bat and soaked in the rare spotlight that recognition finally brought.